

Principles for Arterial Street Space Usage in Washington, DC

Adopted unanimously February 12, 2025

The Multimodal Accessibility Advisory Council proposes the following priorities (in order) for arterial street space in the District of Columbia, aligned with our vision for quality of life, accessibility, efficiency, and sustainability.

Priorities for arterial street space, in order

- 1 **ADA-compliant sidewalks on both sides of the street**, free from obstructions (e.g. utility poles, tree roots, snow, trash bins) **(first priority)**
- 2 **24/7 dedicated, protected lanes for public transit and emergency vehicles**
- 3 **ADA pickup/dropoff zones** exclusively for use by disabled users
- 4 **Protected bike/scooter/power wheelchair lanes** separate from cars and pedestrians (especially when sidewalks are inaccessible)
- 5 **Bike/scooter parking** (daylighting infrastructure) to keep bikes off sidewalks
- 6 **General motor vehicle travel lanes**
- 7 **General (non-ADA) pickup/dropoff zones**
- 8 **ADA-only parking** with 4-hour time limits
- 9 **ADA-accessible parklets and streeteries**
- 10 **Tree boxes and green space**
- 11 **Truly market-priced car parking** **(last priority)**

Key principles for implementation

- Separate vulnerable users from motor vehicles
- Minimize conflicts at intersections and driveways
- Maximize visibility for all users
- Be open to major changes in street design
- Prioritize sidewalk accessibility and safety
- Minimize exceptions for individual circumstances
- Eliminate car delay as a primary consideration

This framework should guide all decisions on DDOT projects to create a more accessible, equitable transportation system.